
Glossary of Key Terms & Full Forms – MessFinder Project

Web & Network Concepts

Term	Full Form	Meaning
HTTP	HyperText Transfer Protocol	Protocol for sending web pages over the internet
HTTPS	HyperText Transfer Protocol Secure	Encrypted version of HTTP using SSL/TLS
URL	Uniform Resource Locator	The address of a web page
IP	Internet Protocol	Addressing system for computers on a network
DNS	Domain Name System	Converts website names to IP addresses
SSL	Secure Sockets Layer	Protocol for encrypting data over the web (<i>deprecated</i>)
TLS	Transport Layer Security	Modern version of SSL for secure web communication
SSH	Secure Shell	Protocol for secure remote access to servers
API	Application Programming Interface	Interface that allows frontend and backend to communicate
REST	Representational State Transfer	Style of API that uses HTTP methods (GET, POST, etc.)

Web App Architectures

Term	Full Form	Meaning
SPA	Single Page Application	Loads once and dynamically updates content without reloading
MPA	Multi Page Application	Loads a new page from the server for each route
SSR	Server-Side Rendering	Page is rendered on the server and sent to client
CSR	Client-Side Rendering	Page is rendered in the browser using JavaScript
CDN	Content Delivery Network	Distributes content globally to reduce load time

Term	Full Form	Meaning
CI/CD	Continuous Integration / Continuous Deployment	Auto build, test, and deploy on code changes

Firestore & Backend Concepts

Term	Full Form	Meaning
NoSQL	Not Only SQL	Flexible database structure, document-based (e.g., Firestore)
UID	Unique Identifier	Unique ID assigned to each authenticated user
JWT	JSON Web Token	Token used to securely transmit user info in auth
CRUD	Create, Read, Update, Delete	Basic database operations

Authentication & Security

Term	Full Form	Meaning
Auth	Authentication	Verifying user identity (e.g., login)
RBAC	Role-Based Access Control	Permissions based on user role (user vs owner)
OTP	One-Time Password	Temporary password for verification
2FA	Two-Factor Authentication	Adds extra layer of security to login
ACL	Access Control List	Rules to control who can access what
MD5	Message Digest 5	Hashing algorithm (insecure today)
SHA	Secure Hash Algorithm	More secure hashing (e.g., SHA-256)
XSS	Cross Site Scripting	Common web security attack
CSRF	Cross-Site Request Forgery	Attack tricking a browser into sending unauthorized commands
DoS	Denial of Service	Attack that floods a system to crash it

Frontend (React + Tools)

Term	Full Form	Meaning
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Term	Full Form	Meaning
JSX	JavaScript XML	React syntax for writing HTML in JavaScript
DOM	Document Object Model	Structure of webpage that JS can manipulate
HMR	Hot Module Replacement	Live updating during development (used in Vite)
Vite	<i>(Not an acronym)</i>	Fast frontend bundler for React/Vue apps
CRA	Create React App	Older tool for starting React projects
npm	Node Package Manager	Tool for managing JS dependencies
CSS	Cascading Style Sheets	Used for styling HTML elements
UI	User Interface	Visual part of the app users interact with
UX	User Experience	Overall experience of the user while using the app
a11y	Accessibility	Making apps usable by people with disabilities

Firestore Services

Term	Full Form	Meaning
Firestore	—	Firestore's scalable NoSQL document database
FBA	Firestore Authentication	Login system for web/mobile apps
FB Storage	Firestore Storage	For uploading and serving user files (e.g., images)
FB Hosting	Firestore Hosting	Static site hosting with SSL and CDN
RTDB	Realtime Database	Firestore's original database (older than Firestore)

Deployment & Version Control

Term	Full Form	Meaning
Git	—	Version control system for tracking code changes
GitHub	—	Platform for hosting code and collaborating on projects
VCS	Version Control System	Manages source code versions
DevOps	Development + Operations	Practices for building, testing, and releasing software quickly
Prod	Production	Final deployed version of your app
Dev	Development	Environment where app is built and tested

